CHAPTER 11

LOOKING EAST

There is an African proverb that says each of us has a decision to make each and every day of our lives. As soon as we wake in the morning, whatever our circumstances, we all have the power to decide whether we look east and see the sunrise or whether we look west and see darkness.

In essence, each of us has the power to decide whether to see the good or the bad in any situation or experience, whether to see the good in people or the bad in people. Apart from extreme circumstances, it seems as if, in everyday life, so much of what we see and feel is ultimately what we choose to see and feel. This applies as much to South African cricket as it does to anything else.

You can review the performance of the Proteas squad over a four-year period between the eve of the 2011 Cricket World Cup and the eve of the 2015 Cricket World Cup, and you can essentially decide whether to see a talented squad that consistently worked hard, that lost only one of 13 series and that very often brought pleasure and pride to millions of their compatriots … or you can decide to see 'chokers' that failed to triumph at the 2011 World Cup or the 2012 World Twenty20 or the 2013 Champions Trophy or the 2014 World Twenty20.

Everyone makes their own choice.

I choose to look east. I choose to recall winning series in both England and Australia in 2012, defeating Pakistan at home and away in 2013 and